NATURAL HEALTH MINISTRIES

Guidebook for NHMEC Students

Module 6



NATURAL HEALTH GUIDEBOOK

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NATURAL HEALTH GUIDEBOOK

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Cover designer: thatsjustpenny
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NATURAL HEALTH

GUIDEBOOK

Book Overview

This book serves as a guide for students of the NHMEC to become a Holistic Christian Herbalist from a Christian viewpoint. It does not intend to prescribe, diagnose, or offer medical treatment. Instead, its goal is to educate readers on utilizing natural resources like herbs, fields, and trees for promoting good health. While herbs do not cure ailments, they do support our bodies and assist in the natural healing process. Ultimately, God is seen as the ultimate healer in this context. The book is designed for educational purposes and is presented from a Christian standpoint.

The author, with over 30 years of experience across various modalities and training, incorporates all her knowledge into her teachings. Her extensive involvement in resources, ministries, companies, books, and classes is reflected in her instructional content.

Holistic
Christian Herbalists



Biblically Based

NATURAL HEALTH GUIDEBOOK

This course covers herbalism from a Christian perspective. The author, Penny Lane Whittemore CNC. BCNWP, CHGp, RHCH is a certified nutritional consultant and a member of various organizations, including the American Association of Nutritional Consultants, Herbalists without Borders, and the Natural Health Ministries Education Center.

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COURSE OUTLINE

DIRECTIONS

MODULES

- MODULE 1 - WELCOME & OREINTATION
- MODULE 2 - CHRISTIAN HERBALIST
- MODULE 3 - THE HERBALIST'S PATH
- MODULE 4 - HOLISTIC NUTRITION
- MODULE 5 - BIBLICAL NUTRITION & WELLNESS
- MODULE 6 - NATURAL HEALTH
- MODULE 7 - BIBLICAL FAITH & HEALTH CONNECTION

Each module is rich in content and will include its own guidebook. However, please ensure that you complete the course through CANVAS CLASSROOM, as not all information can be contained within this guidebook.
Just know that any future updates, corrections, or additions may not be included in the Guidebook.

DIRECTIONS

Please adhere to the Guidebook, as it contains the assignments, questions, and activities. Remember to:

1. Upon purchase of the Program of Study (Course) you should have received the link to enroll in the Holistic Christian Herbalist Course. If you do not notice the link please check your email.
2. PLEASE READ & REVIEW THE STUDENT HANDBOOK found in the Welcome & Orientation Module.
3. Complete the course as it is assigned by each module. The order of modules are important. Some modules contain an entire class while as some contain a link to a course. There are classes and courses within the Program of Study.
4. complete your internship & training
5. receive your accredited diploma of completion via mail

Utilize note-taking, highlighting, sticky notes, etc., to support your learning process. You can export all content to a PDF annotation app, including Canva.

UPON COMPLETION OF THIS COURSE YOU WILL RECEIVE CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETIONs & ELIGBLE FOR A DIPLOMA OF COMPLETION.



When you see this icon it means that you need to refer to the CANVAS COURSE for the Assignment.

STUDENT INFO

STUDENT NUMBER (LOCATED ON YOUR STUDENT ID CARD) _____

NAME _____

CANVAS STUDENT LOGIN _____

PASSWORD _____

ENROLLED DATE _____
START DATE _____

NOTES;

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HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

Penny Lane Whittemore CNC BCNWP CHGp RHCH

Module 6

NATURAL HEALTH

Module 6 - Natural Health





Please consult the CANVAS COURSE to fulfill these assignments. Following the CANVAS COURSE CLASSROOM closely is crucial for completing the course in its entirety.
As the course is being updated more will be available.
MODULE - Natural Health

Assignments:

- Slide Show
- Health Questionnaire
- Health Assessment pdf
- Assignment
- Herbs & Natural Substances pdf
- Natural Health Tips link

The Approach to Natural Health Philosophy

When you think of an herbalist, aromatherapist, or a chiropractor some may say 'alternative medicine' is the method of health care, but some may say it is 'traditional medicine'. However, there is a common ground or a common philosophy-a natural health philosophy.

A natural health philosophy refers to the concepts, techniques, and beliefs practiced by those who believe or practice in natural health. There are many opinions and views about natural health, if it is traditional or alternative. There are similarities that run through all natural health philosophies no matter what area of study.

The idea of natural health philosophy is that the body has the capability of healing itself, if given the right nutrients needed, and under the right circumstances for the body to be working properly. However, in order for healing to occur there may be certain conditions which may need to be met before the healing process can begin. For example a person's body will recover faster if the immune system is working properly which requires the proper nutrition to do so. There are times when a toxic chemical, free radicals, bacteria, or infection must be removed before proper healing can begin. A diseased body can not heal itself without first eliminating the disease or cause or the spiritual root.

According to natural health philosophy, the role of the healer: 1) to locate and remove any obstacles (both physical and emotional and spiritual) that may prevent proper healing; 2) to supply the body with what it may be lacking due to inadequate intake or of any nutrients; and 3) to educate the 'person' as to the principles of good health, and how to maintain their good health.

Not always will the 'person' listen or follow the suggested plan but as a general rule start out slow and work your way up the plan with the whole person in mind. Be patient, give mercy and grace, pray for and encourage the person you are consulting.

The Fundamentals of Health Formula #1 for Some but not all

The Fundamentals of Health, according to a natural health philosophy, is the areas of lifestyle that we must attend to in order to maximize health. The fundamental formula to remember is C, L, E, A, N.

C-Cleanse
L- Leisure
E-Exercise
A-Attitude
N-Nutrition

However, we do not recommend following the CLEAN formula, as a natural health plan for each individual, it is only meant to be as a guide. Cleansing needs to be accessed only if the person's body is able to tolerate the cleansing because it can be quite significant if accessed when the immune system is weak.

Cleansing

Everyone knows that cleaning the outside of the body is very important. It is just as important to clean the inside as well as the outside of the body. Since we depend on our surroundings for the essentials of life—air, food, water, etc.—a clean environment is just as important. This includes clean drinking water; I recommend RO (reverse osmosis) water.

When I say cleanse, I mean to cleanse the intestines, stomach, gallbladder, and kidneys, the systems that eliminate waste products from the body. Without proper elimination the waste products back up causing germs, poison, and parasites to exist.

There are many products on the market that promise to cleanse the colon, and etc. but if you want a true cleanse you need to cleanse all four main systems, and not just one. I recommend a foot detoxify that is for all four systems, and or a cleansing formula from Nature Sunshine that targets all four main systems.

Did you know that the average American consumes five pounds of chemical food additives per year? Some will say even more, over 135 lbs in one year. Do you know how long that would take to rid the body of the additives? It takes around 30 glasses of water to flush 1 (8 oz) can of soda out of the body.

When we don't get enough fiber and true fat in our food consumption, the movement of the intestines is slowed, promoting the build up of waste material and toxins in the bowel, liver and blood possibly causing dry stool.

Sad to say but to prolong shelf life modern food processors have removed most of the fibers and fats from our foods, causing us to eat too many foods, such as meat and dairy products, that contain no fiber at all. Even the well known cereals that claim to be high in fiber contain gluten which sticks to the intestinal walls and slows down the process of what little fiber is present in the cereal. Fiber acts like a broom, helping sweep chemicals and toxins through the intestinal tract. Have you thought about the nuts, corn, and seeds that do not get removed from the intestines, colon, or bowel due to improper elimination of waste? That is why I recommend taking fiber supplements, and or eating the herbs/foods that contain the fiber needed.

The term "colon cleansing" can be a little misleading, as stated before, because true cleansing means much more than simply taking a laxative to empty the bowels. A good herbal cleanse will not only improve elimination but will aid all of the organs and tissues that have an eliminative function including, not only the colon or bowel, but the liver, lungs, skin, blood, and kidneys as well. The herbal cleansing product that Nature Sunshine carries is Clean Start and has been recommended by many Naturopathic Doctors. Also as stated before a good foot detox bath recipe can jumpstart the elimination of waste fluids from the body, if conducted in the proper way. You will learn more about detox later on in the course.

I do not recommend that people who are thin, pale, in a weakened condition begin with a cleanse. Such people should begin by building their body up with minerals, vitamins, and nutrients. We also do not recommend cleansing for women who are pregnant or lactating. For the rest of us, it is a good idea to begin a holistic nutritional health program with a cleanse, however, please be advised this is only one formula of a natural health plan.

There are many forms and techniques of cleansing. Please be sure of the cleansing method before attempting to cleanse the body. Over cleansing the body can be just as harmful as not cleansing. A lesson on detox has been added to this course for the knowledge of proper techniques of cleansing.

Note it can be very harmful to cleanse a body system that is weak.

Leisure

Leisure; rest, relaxation, prayer and sleep. Sufficient rest is necessary for physical and mental restoration. Sleep is essential for our well-being, but it isn't just the quantity of sleep, it's the quality that's so important. You can consider meditation/prayer to be an important part of this fundamental of health. However, I do not teach or instruct on meditation, for personal beliefs, however, it may interest some of you. I like to introduce prayer instead of meditation. Meditating on the Lord and all of his goodness is not the same practice as the 'meditation' practices.

Prayer, relaxation all can benefit the healing properties of the human body. Having a calm body and a calm mind can set the mood for the body to start the healing process. If a person's body is so tight that the muscles are constricted, those muscles are not going to absorb the proper nutrients that they need to perform. For example magnesium is absorbed through the muscles, so if the muscles are too tight the magnesium will not be absorbed properly causing the magnesium just to be eliminated.

Exercise

Believe it or not, exercise is an important part of our energy level. However, the exercise of circulating the blood to allow for more oxygen to flow through the red blood cells is not the normal way of exercise. Exercise for some body types can absolutely do more harm.

However, with our busy lives we often think that exercise means a total body workout hours, and hours per day, wrong; our bodies best benefit from light exercise instead of heavy brisk exercise. I recommend light aerobics, walking, and of course the main exercise that contributes to optimal health is swimming.

Light exercise for at least 15 to 20 minutes, three times a week, is a fundamental of health and a fundamental of weight loss and lifetime maintenance. Exercise programs do not necessarily have to include intense activities such as jogging or running. A brisk walk at a comfortable pace is an ideal exercise for most people. Since walking is less vigorous than running or jogging, we should ideally try to do it for at least 20-40 minutes at a time, if health permits, gradually building up your endurance level. Never start an exercise regimen without gradually working yourself, or stamina up.

There are special exercise programs that are proper for each individual's needs, such as the elderly who may not be able to stand for long periods of time, there is the band exercise program that incorporates proper breathing techniques.

There are many exercise programs out there to fit everyone's physical ability, the body type, and blood type. Finding the correct one is the key. I recommend the band exercise programs or the wand exercise as some call them. An exercise assessment should be planned according to the person's body systems and their needs.

Attitude

A good attitude can go a long way promoting a healthy immune system. By listening to yourself or as some say 'self talk' you become aware of your thoughts if negative or positive. Spiritual practices, such as prayer, are often the best ways to help us improve our attitudes. Music also helps to relieve stress and releases the happy hormone, and of course none other than laughter.

Having a positive mind set, binding your mind to the mind of Christ in daily prayer. Stopping the lying spirits, critical mindset that does nothing but criticize, belittle, judge of total negativity needs to be addressed and put into its place, under the blood of Jesus. Casted off and sent to the feet of Jesus.

The mind is an inner identity that stores, remembers, contains the every essence of our life from the beginning of conception. The brain, the organ, is the store center, and the host of our mind.

Nutrition

As the old saying goes, "you are what you eat," it is all too true. Whatever nutrients that you place in your stomach are what your body has to perform on. If you ingest processed foods all of the time then your body is performing on preservatives, antibiotics, and other synthetics contents. Eventually if the by-products are not eliminated properly those products can become toxic to the body.

For a healthy nutrition plan I recommend following a few guidelines to go by 1) check pH levels 2) know the individual's blood type 3) consider food allergies and or disease such as Celiac or IBS. Foods first, supplements last.

Is it Necessary to Supplement?
In order to maintain our maximum health potential throughout a lifetime, I believe that it is necessary to supplement our diets with the items that we can not obtain in our consumed foods, by herbal supplements or by eating the proper organic foods needed.

Due to modern farming, overworking of the soil, pesticide use, run offs, machine emissions, etc. the foods we eat today are lacking many trace minerals, and vitamins. Several foreign countries can not grow certain foods because their soil does not contain the essential nutrients that it needs, such as selenium. Selenium is needed for gut health. Food processing modern methods designed to extend shelf-life destroy many important nutrients—especially vitamins, enzymes, fiber, minerals, and phytonutrients.

I do recommend eating organic foods, herbs and or taking the herbal supplements needed to replace the items lost in our foods to obtain optimal health. Now remember when I refer to 'optimal health' this means the highest level of health that your body can reach and maintain under today's circumstances.

Now keep in mind that everyone's 'optimal health' is not the same for everyone. Levels of weaknesses and possible damage to body systems in some cases may not be able to be addressed.

The ABC plus D Approach Plan #2 for some but not all

In today's modern world it is important to supplement foods that you consume. Most people are confused about what they really need to be supplementing. Every individual has different biological needs based on their lifestyle choices, genetic makeup, and body systems. The slogan, 'one size fits all' doesn't work when it comes to natural health.

The ABC plus D approach is a specific plan to help you develop an individualized nutritional program that will allow you to get the most benefit. Did you know that the supplements out there on the market are on an average set the dosage for a 150 lb person?

A=Activate
B=Build
C=Cleanse
D=Direct Aid

The A stands for Activate

The human body has the capability of healing itself, providing it has sufficient energy and nutrients. However, after years of stress or neglect, or from eating too many processed foods, the body's self-healing can become sluggish. This is where the body requires enzymes. Many foods contain enzymes but the cooking process destroys them, so the foods will be lacking in the nutrients needed. Foods that are high in enzymes are fresh sprouted seeds, like alfalfa or broccoli sprouts, papaya, and so on. Even adding fermented foods will give the gut the good bacteria that the gut needs to fully absorb the needed enzymes.

Enzymes are actually made by the body. However, if the body becomes toxic, sluggish, etc, then the enzymes will not be sufficient enough to complete their original purpose.

When going to the supermarket look at the 4 digit code, for example the stickers on bananas read 4104. According to research the FDA uses the four digit numbers to specify the process of the fresh foods such as hybrids or GMO's. The numbers to look for regarding organic numbering are 4 and 9. The numbers that are GMO's or hybrids are 3 and 6, and so on.

Plant enzymes are also available as a dietary supplement. In order to stimulate the body's energy systems—especially its self-healing systems a plant enzyme supplement may be suggested. However, remember that fiber is also needed in order for the enzymes to work properly. So there is where a balanced holistic nutritional health plan is needed.

The B Stands for Build

Most of the foods we eat today have been heavily processed. This increases their shelf-life, but it also destroys many vitamins and phytonutrients, chemical compounds like beta-carotene that is found in plants, and modern farming practices have depleted our soils of many trace minerals, and if you have ever raised a garden you know that the food is only as good as its soil.

We can no longer rely on our food for all the vitamins and minerals necessary to achieve optimal health. That is why some recommend that everyone include a high-quality natural multi-vitamin and trace mineral supplement in their nutritional program.

The C stands for Cleanse

Cleansing, as I spoke of earlier, allows proper elimination to occur in the body, therefore producing more energy. As stated before, cleansing not only means the outside but the inside of the body using a cleanse for the entire body systems that eliminate not just the colon.

The D stands for Direct Aid

The majority of us have one or more body systems that may be weaker than the others and need some nutritional support. The body systems include; digestive, intestinal, circulatory, nervous, immune, respiratory, glandular, urinary, structural systems.

Nature's Sunshine has developed a Health Analysis Questionnaire that can help you determine your weakest body systems(s).

Once you have determined the weakest body system, a specific "Key Product" can be included in your nutritional program to support that system. There is a Key Product for each of the body's nine systems. Key Products are vitamin/herbal combinations that support the health of a whole body system, rather than targeting a specific problem or symptom. These you will find in the course.

If you have more than one body system that is in need of support then it is usually best to target your worst system first. After a few months you can retake the health analysis questionnaire to see what kind of progress you have made. At that time you might decide to target another system instead of, or in addition to, the original system(s). Now remember, it may take up 1 month to 6 months to see a difference, and remember to check any prescription drug or OTC drug interactions before recommending any herbal supplement. You can go to www.drugs.comLinks to an external site. to see if there are any interactions.

This is where a journal is needed for the person to fill out each month so that the consultant can review to see if there has been changes in energy, mood, sleep, etc. The journal can be a key also in food sensitivities and allergies.

With herbal supplements you need to make sure the ingredients contain what is good for the body. Some products contain baking soda, corn starch, and food additives that usually can not be processed by the body. So therefore it either is eliminated or ends up in the body stored up somewhere to cause even more harm.

Natural Health Plan #3

Analyze
Nourish
Change
Cleanse
Supplement
Refer (if needed)

My natural health plan; a system approach to maintain overall health by the body systems, that I have developed involves several steps: (1) Analyze- an evaluation is made to determine the weakest body system(s) by a health analysis questionnaire, including all medical history, and prescription drug or OTC use, an in person evaluation of chosen diagnostic skills if desired such as; fingernail analysis, tongue analysis, iridology, and Quantum Magnetic Health Analysis. (2) Nourish- pH home test kit to determine the overall health of a person (recommended Nature Sunshine Product) (3) Change- A food consumption change is also required. I recommend Eat Right for your Blood Type Diet in reference to the pH level of the person or Keto designed by Dr. Berg (4) Cleanse- even detox, the total cleansing of the eliminating systems (5) Supplements- nutritional supplements are chosen to support the weakest body systems according to the health analysis questionnaire or the QMHA, being sure to check www.drugs.comLinks to an external site. for any supplement or OTC or prescription drug interactions that the person may be taking or recommend herbal formularies (6) refer to someone else if needed or recommend lab test to be done.

This process takes time. I like to start out with seeing how healthy you really are by a pH 3 day test then by creating a proper nutrition plan that refers to the person's pH. In other words I will start with the gut and how well the body gets its nutrients. Knowing what foods to eat has been known to give the body the jumpstart that it needs to activate the body systems and to regulate them. Then from there after 1 month of food consumption change I will proceed with herbs, and herbal supplements. Finalysing after a few months of nourishing the body, allowing the gut to be at optimal level then a detox will be suggested.

Follow up visits are required to maintain communication and to record progress. Step #1 and #3 of the natural health plan needs to be repeated often. Even a phone consultation is better than none at all. Journals are a great way for the person to record their progress to be read by the consultant at the repeated visits.

There are many approaches that can be used when determining someone's natural health plan. I have discussed 3 others briefly that I built my plan around. You can be sure that each plan can be adjusted to fit any individual's needs.

(1) Analyze-I begin with a 3 day pH check either using the PH strips or the QMHA machine to see how healthy that you are currently, you will learn how later, and then the health analysis from Nature Sunshine products to determine the weakest body system. I will test the PH of the person using a saliva strip that they will conduct on their own. I will read the strip and take a photo. Then I will give the person a 3 day journal to record, read the results of the strip. During the next consultation visit the person will bring back the journal with the results for the consultant to review and place in the person's file. I only keep records for my personal database. Records are not shared with the person or printed to be given out. These records are for educational purposes only.

If interested in an in person analysis, looking at the person's body can be done. A person's body can tell many things if the person is willing to listen. There are many other diagnostic skills such as fingernail analysis, tongue analysis, iridology, and so on. Now remember you are not diagnosing but suggesting.

I have a huge amount of paperwork that I have designed and put together for the analysis part of the consultation, however, I do not ask about any health issues or OTC drugs, or prescription drugs, etc, until all of the analysis is over. I do not wish to know anything about what is going on with symptoms or anything until the analysis process has started. This way the person you are consulting will know that you are legit. I will ask questions during the analysis consultation part of the holistic nutritional health consultation process. Sometimes people are surprised that you will be able to say certain things without even telling you.

Once all of the analysis has been completed I proceed into asking the individual about the prescription drugs or OTC drugs already taking. Believe it or not herbal supplements, and herbs can interact with these drugs, so from the beginning you need to know what those may be. For example if someone is on blood pressure medicine you need not to recommend a product for example Blood Pressurex that would interact with the prescription drug or an herb like Hawthorn.

(2) Nourish the Body-A pH test kit tells if the body is acidic or alkaline(if the QMHA Analysis has been performed then you can skip this step). Certain foods if eaten can benefit the pH level. You will learn more about pH levels later on. Knowing your pH can tell you if your digestive system is too slow or to fast, so therefore the food enzyme supplements come in handy, along with fiber supplements.

(3) Change- A food consumption change in most cases is necessary to jump start the body systems into eliminating properly. The Blood Type Diet is an excellent way to begin changing the diet, keeping in mind the pH level as well. If you formulate the food consumption plan to fit the individual's chemical makeup, blood type, eye type, etc. then it gives the body the extra start that it needs by providing the right nutrients in the right formula for each body type. You will learn more about all of those things later on. Nourishing the body can jump start the elimination process and make cleansing a little easier.

(4) Cleanse- Once the body has been built up, the pH level in normal range, and the eliminating, and digestive systems working properly it is time to cleanse the entire body. There are several methods of cleansing. I like to choose a foot detox, it is a mild detox to get started with that targets the main systems of elimination, and not just one. If done correctly a foot detox performed 1 week out of a year can benefit greatly. It doesn't take a harsh detox to begin getting the body to self-heal. You will learn more about detox later on.

(5) Supplements- After the first four steps are maintained the next step is to add the supplements needed to maintain this balance. Many people believe you have to take a capsule to supplement the body but you can actually eat the foods that contain the nutrients that the body needs instead of taking capsule form of supplements. I believe first to eat the things needed, then go to the supplements, however, in this busy world eating right may not be convenient for everyone, so the supplements are then applied. They travel well for busy people. However, there are many ways that you can prepare the foods in a to-go style like fruit and vegetable roll up, dried or candied foods, smoothies and shakes, etc.

This 5 step process is just that: a process it takes months to jumpstart the body for self-healing to take over. Once the self-healing begins then it is up to us to maintain the healing to reach our optimal health. Remember it takes months for herbs to work unlike prescription drugs that take anywhere from 1 minute to 30 minutes to start working in the body. Herbs need to be built up in the body to gain the full benefits from them.

Health Analysis Questionnaire

Once you have determined the weakest system using this questionnaire, you can select the herbal/nutritional supplements that are recommended by Nature Sunshine Products, and with the other lessons that are provided in this course a more in depth evaluation can be hopefully performed. Be sure to always remember to refer to the prescription and OTC drug use interaction guide. I have provided you for a reference guide to go by when studying the prescription and OTC drug interaction with herbal supplements.

The Health Analysis Questionnaire is a very simple but powerful tool that can help you modify a successful nutritional/herbal supplementation program without the guesswork. You can employ the additional diagnostic references as well throughout this course to help consult as a successful layperson working legally.

The Health Analysis Questionnaire by Nature Sunshine is perfectly safe, legal, and ethical for lay people to use. Just remember not to diagnose, promise a cure, or misrepresent an herb or a nutritional product as a treatment or a cure all for a specific condition, disease, ailment, etc.

Retaking the health analysis every two months, the iridology reading every three months, or the Quantum Health Analyzer every 2 weeks can help to recognize which body system is benefiting from the natural health plan, and checking the pH once a month as well. A change may need to be added to ensure proper maintenance.

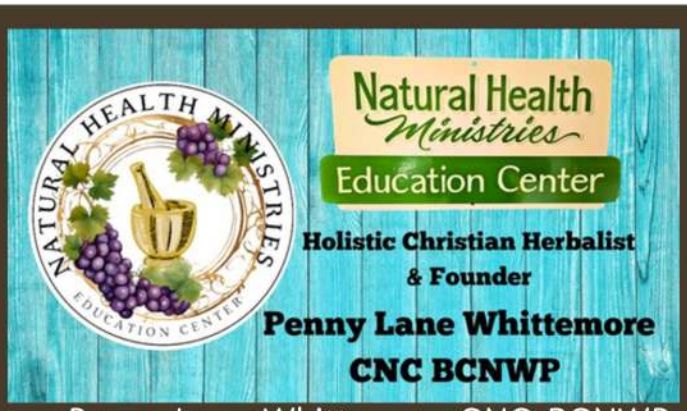
(6) Refer-to refer an individual to someone else is not bad. If you have tried all that you can, changing the natural health plan several times, or feel that more can be done then lab tests may be required.

Referring a client to someone else isn't saying that you can not help them, it is saying that another option may be needed. For example Spiritual Deliverance or Spiritual Counseling. Don't be ashamed to ask for help or ask the client for additional needed tests. I often refer people to a chiropractor, a homeopathic friend who has his own lab equipment, a friend who is a licensed doctor, etc. By referring to others shows the client that you are out for their better good, and being a teacher as well as a consultant.

In order to fully understand my natural health plan more studying needs to be done before going any further; the body systems need to be addressed, pH level training for maintaining the proper level, nutrition, proper cleansing methods, and studying the proper herbs and supplements for each body system is all required.







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